

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 7
 ♥ 9 5 4
 ♦ 10 9 5 2
 ♣ J 10 9 7

♠ K 5

♥ Q 8 6

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ K Q 8 6



♠ J 10 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ K J 8 4

♣ A 5 3

♠ A 9 8 6 2

♥ K J 10 7 2

♦ 6

♣ 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South

East trump play was good defense; it has prevented you from ruffing 2 ♠s in dummy. Even so your best plan will be to establish the ♠ suit.

So you next play ♠K, ♠A, then ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥Q. West does not follow to the third ♠.

Next play ♦A and get to your hand by ruffing a ♦. Pull the last trump, then give up a ♠ to East. Win his return, (by ruffing if necessary) and take your established ♠ winner and dummy's ♣K.

Suppose you had considered taking the ♦ finesse. It would have done you no good at all.

If it worked, all you could do would be to discard your fifth ♠; but that was the ♠ that turned out to be a winner!

It was the fourth ♠ that was a loser, and you couldn't get rid of that one.

Partner's bid is a transfer asking you to bid 2♠, so you do. Partner now bids 3♥;

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Partner is showing 5-5 in the Majors, with at least invitational strength. It's a close thing, but you decide to accept the invitation and bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣J. You play the ♣Q. East wins with the ♣A and plays the ♥A then the ♥3.

Loser List: ♠ = 1/2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3/4

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 7
♥ J 5
♦ Q J 9 2
♣ J 10 4 3

♠ A 9 6 4

♥ 8 7 6 2

♦ K 7 5

♣ K 6



♠ Q 8 3 2
♥ K Q 10
♦ 10 8 3
♣ Q 7 5

♠ K 5

♥ A 9 4 3

♦ A 6 4

♣ A 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South

cannot make it), and also assumes you will be able to cross-ruff 4 small black cards.

With 10 points and two 4-card Majors you bid 2♣ Stayman. Partner says 2♥;

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Now you add a point for your doubleton, get to 11 points, and bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦Q. Win the ♦Q in either hand. Lets say you win with your ♦A.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2* : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3*

*Don't get overconfident with this loser list. It assumes that trumps break 3-2, (if they don't you

Cross-ruffing those 4 losers could be a problem. You can't afford to get over-ruffed so it would be nice if you could pull some trumps before you start the cross-ruff. But you must make sure that only two rounds of trumps get pulled, otherwise you won't have the trumps for the cross-ruff.

It is actually simple to make sure exactly two rounds of trumps are drawn. At trick 2 just duck a ♥ in each hand. An opponent will win this, but you can take the next trick, (probably a ♦), and then pull a second round of trumps with your ♥A. Then leave the trumps alone and play your two black A K's, then start cross-ruffing with your 4 tiny trumps. The defender with the master trump can over-ruff when he can, and can even cash a ♦. But that's all he can do so you will make your game.

Suppose you had played first the ♥A, then a small ♥.

East would have won the second one, and if he had then continued ♦s you would have made the contract.

But if he was a good enough defender to pull a THIRD round of trumps, getting 2 for the price of 1 value, you would have been defeated.